Quest Core & Information

Quest Name: Same Old Mysterious Tracks
(If the rest the Side Quest is triggered: Like One Who Once Had Wings)

Quest Type: Initially a Monster Hunt quest
(If triggered: Side Quest)

Monster - Fiend

Location - Lindenvale & Novigrad

Prerequisites

- Must finish the “Witcher Wannabe” Side Quest (10-12 in game days after) or any time if the side quest (“Witcher Wannabe”) was not initiated.
- Get a contract from a Notice Board in Oreton, Downwarren, or Lindenvale.

Themes and design intent

- Create a Gated Quest - players get rewarded with extra content by paying more attention to the details
- Break the School Archetype - Ironically the School of Griffin is somewhat “honor coded” witcher school, however this witcher breaks that character or canon.
- Show Economic reality of being a Witcher - Due to contracts being rare and us as players actively taking the contracts we can show how other witchers can struggle with earning money.

Logline

A routine monster contract in a village leads Geralt to a fellow witcher whose protection of the locals hides a darker truth

Synopsis

Geralt finds a contract on a Notice Board, the village of Lindenvale is in desperate need of a witcher to deal with a monster that has been terrorizing them for weeks. When Geralt asks the villagers of Lindenvale about it, he learns that another witcher had been protecting the village for some time in exchange for regular payment. However after the price of his services grew beyond what the village could afford, the witcher left. Shortly after his departure, a new set of various monsters began appearing near the village, and the villagers decided to find someone who could help.

One of the rather larger issues was a monster who reminded the villagers of a “chort” like monster who has been stealing sheep and other animals from their farm. Geralt tracks the creature to a nearby cave and slays it, only to discover signs that the Fiend was lured there deliberately(as he is an inhabitant of northern regions of Velen and Skellige). The herbs and compounds used to draw it remind of the marks of witcher alchemy. Returning to the village, Geralt can begin to investigate what really happened to the previous witcher and where he went.

The trail leads to Novigrad, where Geralt finds the witcher Tolard Nas of the School of the Griffin and uncovers the truth, Tolard has been luring monsters to Lindenvale for some time now, killing them for inflated fees.

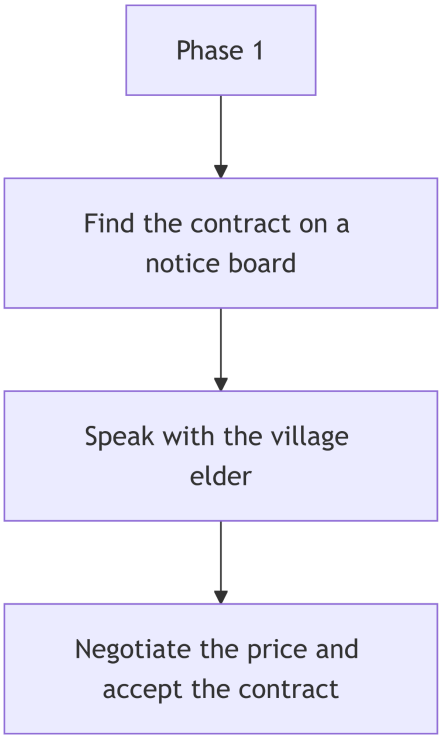
Quest Structure

- - Actions/Objectives
⌘ - Dialogues
⌬ - Journal/Notes

Phase 1 - Hook

- Take the contract for a monster hunt from the Notice Board.
⌘ Approach the Elder who tells about the monster and briefly mentions that another witcher used to defend the village from similar threats.
    - (One or two sentences from the previous witcher is not the focus of this conversation yet.)
⌘ Negotiate the price and accept the contract.
- Go to the nearby forest, where the monster has been sighted.

Flow Chart:



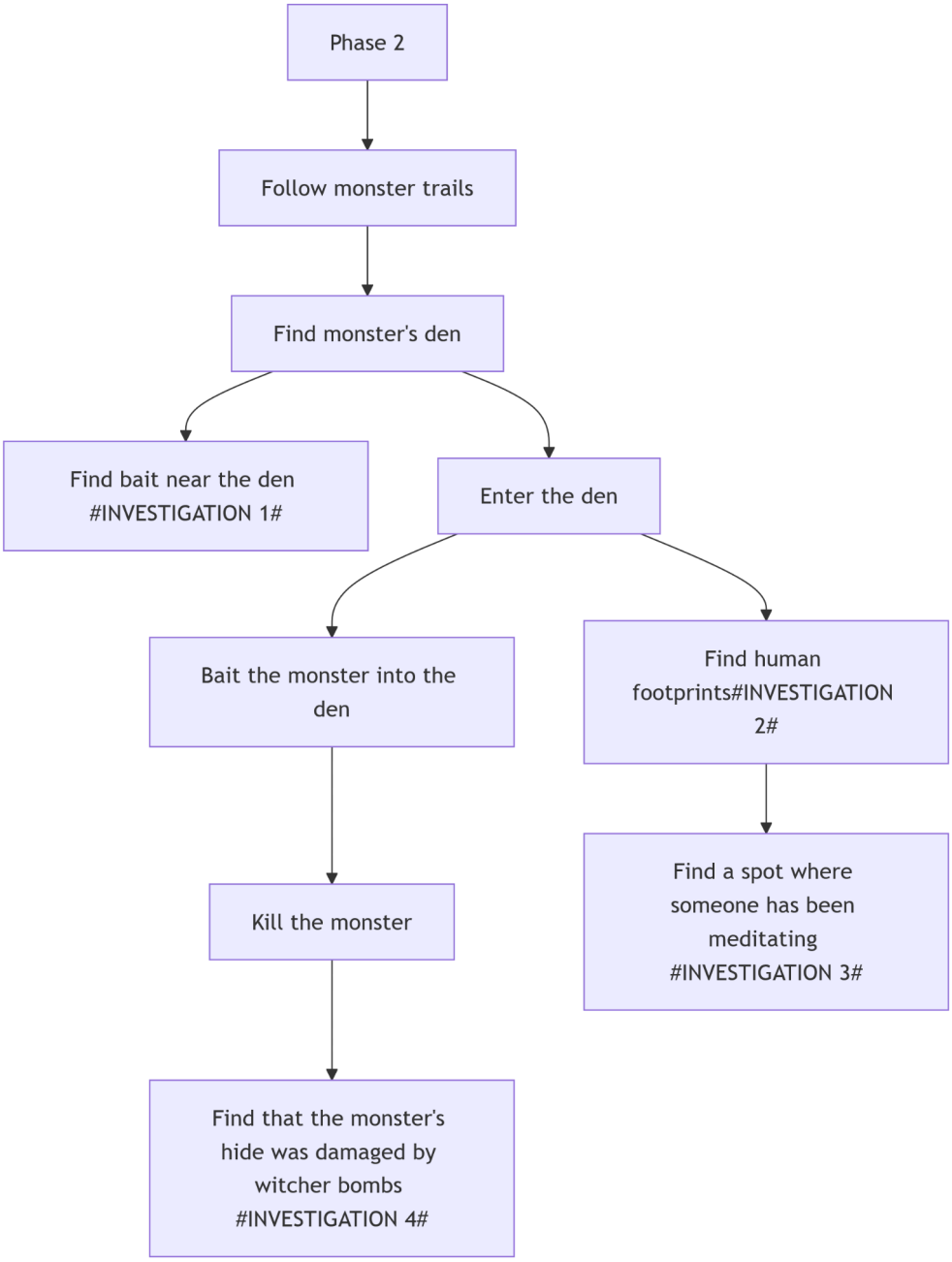
Phase 2 - False Contract (Monster Hunt)

~This Monster Hunt is based on “Mysterious Tracks” Contract.

- Search the forest using Witcher Senses.
- Follow the monster's tracks.
- Locate the source of the scent trail.
- Find a way into the cave.
- Explore the cave using Witcher Senses.
    - ⌘ Geralt can notice a set of human footprints nearby. [INVESTIGATION #1]
    - ⌘ Following the footprints leads to a spot where someone had been meditating. [INVESTIGATION #2]
- Prepare bait using the alchemy formula for the Fiend.
- Place the bait at four points around the hill.
    - ⌘ Geralt senses that there was some bait at two of the four points. [INVESTIGATION #3]
- Wait in the cave for the Fiend to catch the scent.
- Kill the Fiend.
- Take a trophy from the Fiend.
    - ⌘ By inspecting the body, Geralt finds devil's puffball burn marks on the Fiend's hide, indicating that someone with witcher level alchemical knowledge had fought this creature before. [INVESTIGATION #4]

~To suspect that Someone has interacted with the fiend in an irregular way the Player has to get all 4 investigation pieces.

Flow Chart


Phase 2
Follow monster trails
Find monster's den
Find bait near the den #INVESTIGATION 1#
Enter the den
Bait the monster into the den
Find human footprints#INVESTIGATION 2#
Kill the monster
Find a spot where someone has been meditating #INVESTIGATION 3#
Find that the monster's hide was damaged by witcher bombs #INVESTIGATION 4#

Phase 3 - Investigation

- Return to the village and collect the reward from the elder.

~If the player found all 4 Investigation Pieces in Phase 2 Geralt gets a new dialogue with the village's eldest when getting a reward.

- ⌘ Ask the elder more about the witcher who has been defending the village.
- ⌘ Get additional information on the Witcher
  - ⌘ The elder explains that the witcher had protected Lindenvale for some time, but gradually began raising his price until the village could no longer afford him.
  - ⌘ The elder mentions that the witcher used to stay at the village inn.
- ⌘ Go to the inn and question the innkeeper
  - ⌘ Who recalls that monster attacks always seemed to begin whenever the witcher was in residence.
- Investigate the room where the Witcher was staying.
  - ⌬ Find a Journal, where the pages include bestiary notes, day to day thoughts (Hint: his favorite bar), and fragments of him working in Redania.
  - ⌬ (The full story is withheld here, to be delivered by the Witcher himself during the confrontation.)
- Find additional luring potions hidden in the Witcher’s room.
- Travel to a Novigrad pub where the Witcher may be spending his time.
- ⌘ Question the bar workers.
  - ⌘ They confirm that he comes in often, and that he left not that long ago.
- Use Witcher Senses to track the scent of alcohol through the streets.

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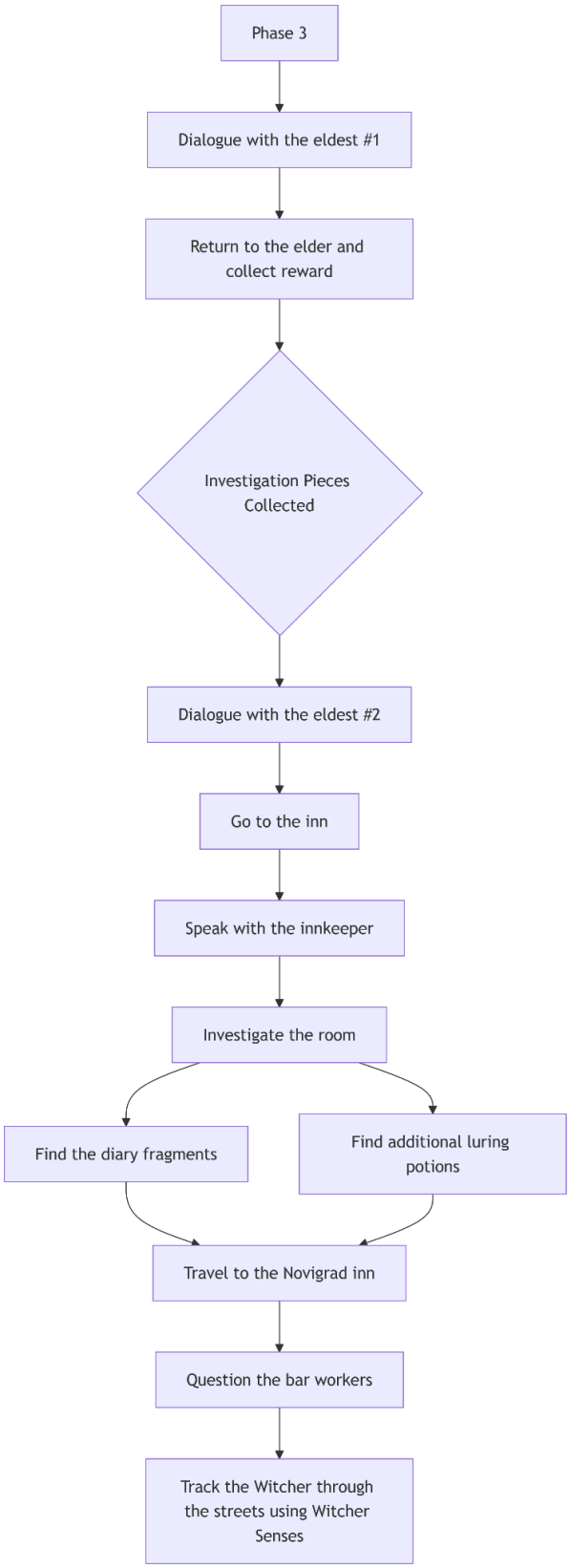
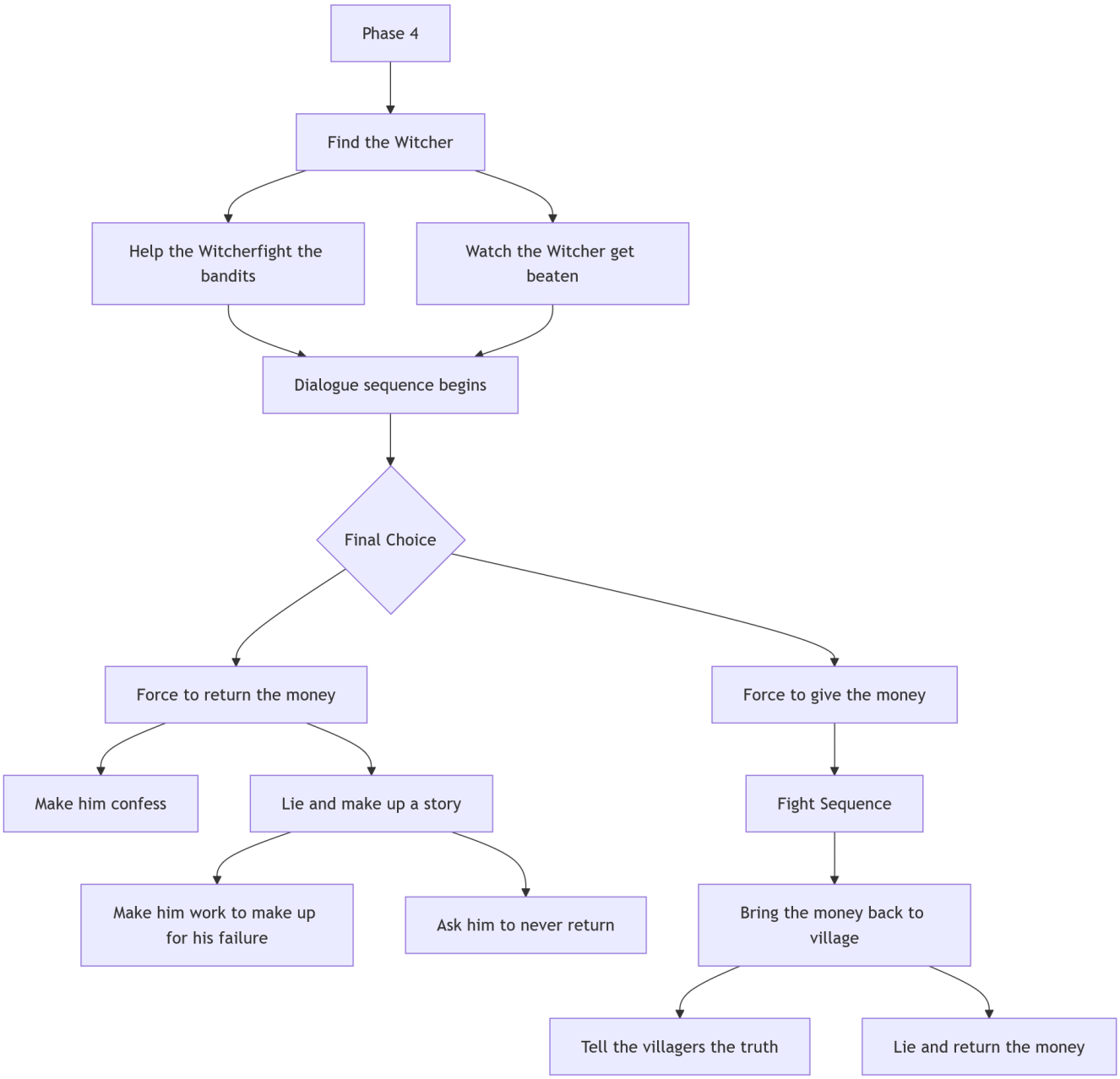

Phase 3
Dialogue with the eldest #1
Return to the elder and collect reward
Investigation Pieces Collected
Dialogue with the eldest #2
Go to the inn
Speak with the innkeeper
Investigate the room
Find the diary fragments
Find additional luring potions
Travel to the Novigrad inn
Question the bar workers
Track the Witcher through the streets using Witcher Senses

Phase 4 - Finale

- Find the Witcher on the street, drunk, trying to pick a fight with several bandits.
- Help the Witcher fight off the bandits or Watch as he gets beaten up.
    - ⌘ Dialogue sequence begins after the fight sequence.
        - ⌘ Learn more about the Witcher, who he is, where he is from, and what he does.
        - ⌘ Ask him about his work protecting the village.
        - ⌘ Push him on what he has done.
        - ⌘ The Witcher breaks down and tells Geralt the truth about Lindenvale.
            - **Final Choices:**
                - Bring the money back to the village yourself.
                - Tell the villagers what Tolard has done.
                - Lie to the villagers and simply return the money.
                - Force the Witcher to bring the money back himself
                - Make him Confess
                - Make up a lie
                - Make him work for the village to make up for his failure
                - Make him leave Velen

Flow Chart


Phase 4
Find the Witcher
Help the Witcherfight the bandits
Watch the Witcher get beaten
Dialogue sequence begins
Final Choice
Force to return the money
Force to give the money
Make him confess
Lie and make up a story
Fight Sequence
Make him work to make up for his failure
Ask him to never return
Bring the money back to village
Tell the villagers the truth
Lie and return the money

Phase 5 - Aftermath

Aftermath A1

- Lindenvale won't have any more contracts in it.

Aftermath A2

- A small grave will be near the village to tribute the witcher that saved them

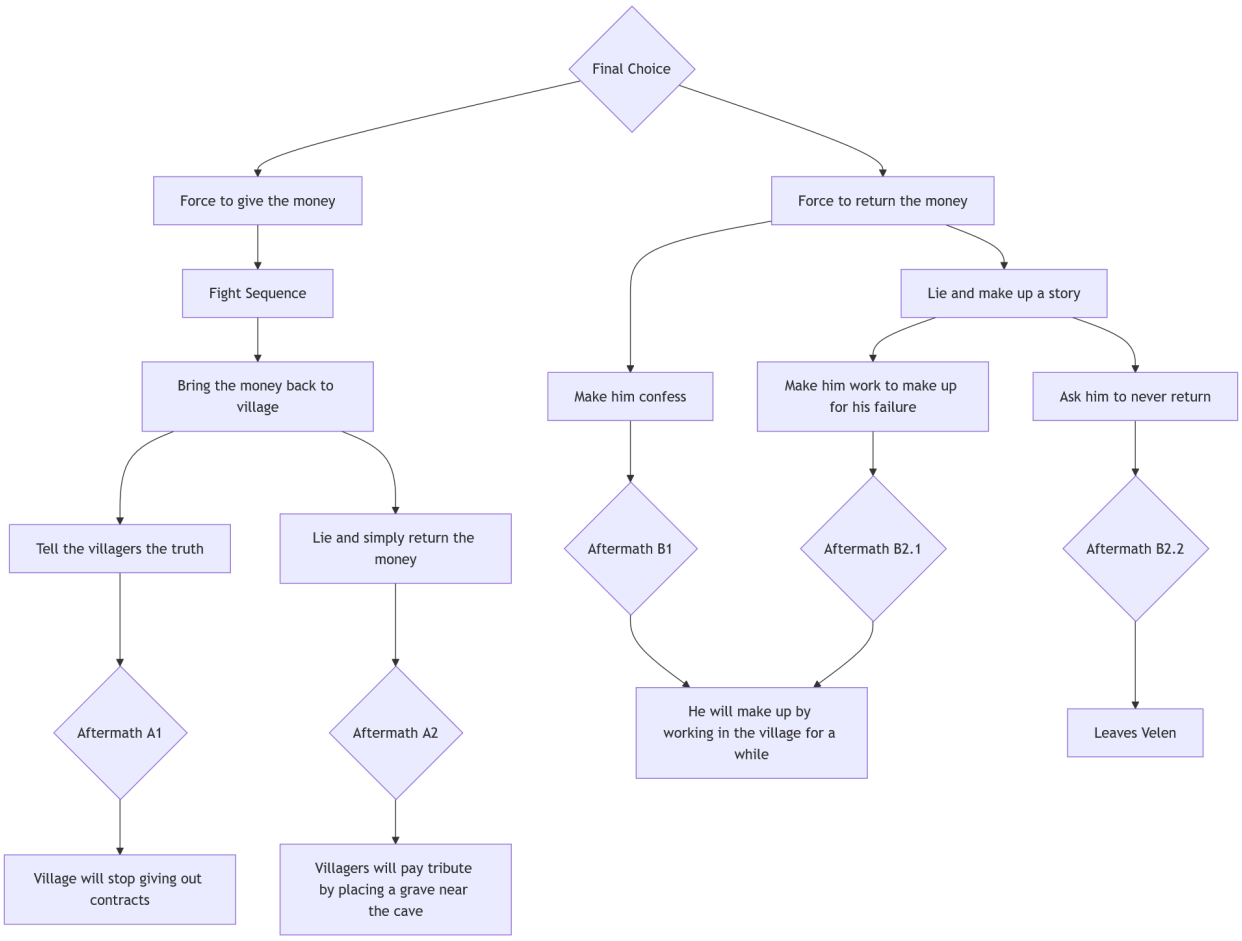
Aftermath B1 & B2.1

- Witcher will be working for the village to make up for what he has done

Aftermath B2.2

- The Witcher will leave Velen.

Flow Chart:


Final Choice
Force to give the money
Force to return the money
Fight Sequence
Lie and make up a story
Bring the money back to village
Make him confess
Make him work to make up for his failure
Ask him to never return
Tell the villagers the truth
Lie and simply return the money
Aftermath B1
Aftermath B2.1
Aftermath B2.2
Aftermath A1
Aftermath A2
He will make up by working in the village for a while
Leaves Velen
Village will stop giving out contracts
Villagers will pay tribute by placing a grave near the cave

Characters

Tolard Nas - Witcher of the School of the Griffin. Originally operated in Redania, However was forced to leave the region due to the Church of Eternal Fire's persecution of witchers which made the work increasingly dangerous. He has moved south, to Velen, hoping a less affected region would let him keep practicing his craft. However Velen's villages were too poor to afford witchers, contracts were rare due to other people (or even witchers) taking the contracts, and every job became a question of whether he could eat that week or not.

When the village of Lindenvale hired him to deal with a Lezsy that has been terrorizing the area, Tolard killed the monster and accepted what was, by Velen standards, a generous reward. He stayed nearby and took a few more contracts from the village for some time. After seeing how villagers were willing to pay him for their own protection he understood that he could earn more money by planting monsters in nearby regions of the village.

NPC	Names	ID (.w2ent)
Lindenvale Eldest	Udravir	nml_villager (crowd_old_01)
Lindenvale Inn keeper	Lese	nml_villager_woman (5)
Novigrad Inn keeper	Thietlion	novigrad_elf_woman
Bar Worker A	Clinami	novigrad_fisstech
Bar Worker B	Effis	nml_villager_woman (17)
The Bandits (4)	Bandit (A-D)	novigrad_rogue_lvl1(01-04)
Bandit Leader	Idom	novigrad_rogue_lvl1(06)

Locations

Lindenvale - Main Location of the story where the Player will have to investigate the inn as well as its surrounding Forest for Monster Hunt and Investigation sections of the quest.

The Forest South Eastern to Lindenvale - Monster tracking sequence in Phase 2 and the approach to the cave.

Cave - Site of the Fiend hunt, the meditation spot discovery, and three of the four Phase 2 investigation piece

Lindenvale Inn - Witchers haunt in Phase 3

Novigrad Inn - location of the bar worker dialogue that provides the lead to track him down

Novigrad Street - Site of the bandit fight and the full Phase 4 confrontation with Tolard